A-A-30140
December 1, 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BLADE, SURGICAL KNIFE, DETACHABLE

The General Service Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers surgical knife blades used in operative procedures.

Salient characteristic. Blade, Surgical, Knife, shall be detachable, sterile, carbon steel (composed of: Carbon content not less than 1.20 percent, Silicon content not less than 0.10 percent, Manganese content not less than 0.20 percent, Chromium content not less than .10 percent, Sulphur content not less than 0.025 percent, Phosphorus content not less than 0.025 percent, hardness of finished blade shall be Rockwell 30N 75.5 to 83.

Thickness of blade - the part of the blade which is adjacent to the perforation and which fits into the groove of the nose of the handle shall be 0.0145 to 0.0165 inch thick. The remainder of the blade shall be 0.0145 to 0.0212 inch thick, except that it may be thicker along the back edge as a means of reinforcement. Blades shall fit securely and shall be easily detachable from the handles for which they are designed.

The blade point and cutting edge shall be surgically sharp.

Each blade shall be legibly marked with the commercial designation number and name or registered trademark of the manufacturer.

Each blade shall be individually packaged and shall contain an anticorrosive strip/device in blade envelope to prevent corrosion. One narrow edge of the envelope shall extend a minimum of 3/8 inch beyond the seal forming two flaps in such a manner as to permit easy removal of the contents by sterile techniques.

FSC 6515

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Sterility. The blade shall be sterile, free from pyrogens and have a minimum of sterility assurance level (SAL) of 0.000001.

Unit. The unit of issue shall appear on the solicitation.

The workmanship shall be first class throughout The blade shall be free from pits, nicks, burs, improper grind marks, rust, corrosion, oil, and grease.

Type I - Blade size 10 to fit a No. 3 or 7 knife handle.

Type II - Blade size 11 to fit a No. 3 or 7 knife handle.

Type III - Blade size 15 to fit a No. 3 or 7 knife handle.

Type IV - Blade size 20 to fit a No. 4 knife handle.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification: The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act - If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials - The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking - Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

TYPE	NATIONAL STOCK NUMBER	DESCRIPTION
I	6515-01-303-3260	Blade, Surgical Knife, Detachable, Size 10
II	6515-01-304-6419	Blade, Surgical Knife, Detachable, Size 11
III	6515-01-305-3773	Blade, Surgical Knife, Detachable, Size 15
IV	6515-01-298-4583	Blade, Surgical Knife, Detachable, Size 20

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Copies of Federal Standard No. 376, Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20420.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herin, and include the following information in procurement document:

(a) Title, number and date of the commercial item description.
(b) Type

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

DoD-MB

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS VAMKC (904)
Agent VA-OSS VACO (92A)

AGENT:

DLA-DM

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Project No. 6515-0003

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